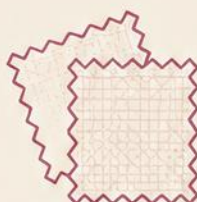


The Foundations Trilogy

Three short guides to get you from zero to your first finished Kinusaiga piece — method, fabric & colour pairing, and craft technique.



A BONUS OF THE SILK ATELIER — \$35 VALUE

Guide 1 of 3 • THE FOUNDATIONS TRILOGY

The Handbook



What Is Kinusaiga?

Kinusaiga is a centuries-old Japanese fabric art in which small pieces of cut fabric are tucked, edge by edge, into grooves cut in a foam board panel — no needle, no glue holding the fabric itself, no sewing experience required. The result looks hand-painted but is entirely built from cloth.

WHY IT WORKS FOR BEGINNERS



No sewing skill needed —
only cutting and tucking



Mistakes are easy to fix —
just re-tuck the patch



One evening is enough
for a small piece

Materials Checklist

WHAT YOU NEED — UNDER \$10

- ☐ Foam board panel, 5mm thick
- ☐ A sharp craft cutter or X-Acto knife
- ☐ Fabric scraps in varied colours — cotton or quilting cotton works best
- ☐ A pair of fabric scissors
- ☐ Straight pins to hold your printed template
- ☐ A cutting mat to protect your table

Everything on this list fits in a shoebox.



FOAM BOARD PANEL



CRAFT CUTTER
OR X-ACTO KNIFE



FABRIC SCRAPS



FABRIC SCISSORS



STRAIGHT PINS

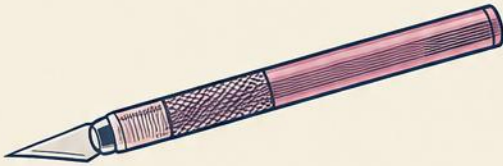


CUTTING MAT

Tools In Detail

CHOOSING YOUR CUTTER

A craft knife gives you precision and control, which is ideal for delicate tucking work and tight corners. A rotary cutter is faster and great for long, straight cuts, but it can be less accurate in small or intricate areas. For beginners, a fine-point craft knife is the best choice — it's easy to handle, affordable, and gives you the control you need to get clean, neat results.



CRAFT KNIFE

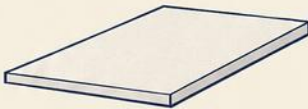
Precise, controlled, ideal for detailed tucking work.



ROTARY CUTTER

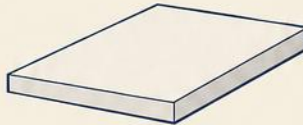
Fast, great for long cuts, less precise in tight spaces.

FOAM BOARD THICKNESS



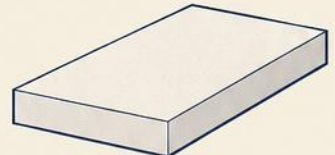
3mm

FOAM BOARD



5mm

FOAM BOARD



8mm

FOAM BOARD

Use 3mm foam board for small templates and 5–8mm for larger templates.

Choosing Your First Template

START WITH AN EASY DESIGN

For your first project, we recommend starting with a simple Easy-difficulty design — like a single flower or a simple crescent moon — before moving on to more detailed Medium-Hard pieces. It's a great way to get comfortable with the process, build your confidence and enjoy the experience.



Easy

Fewer patches, larger regions, and simpler shapes. A single flower or crescent moon is a perfect example.



Easy-Medium

More patches and smaller regions, with a bit more detail and variety in shape and color.



Medium-Hard

Many small, detailed regions, finer shapes and more complex areas. Best saved for when you're ready for a challenge.

Printing To Scale

PRINT AT 100%

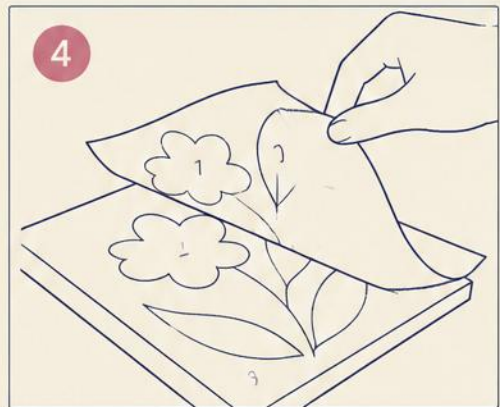
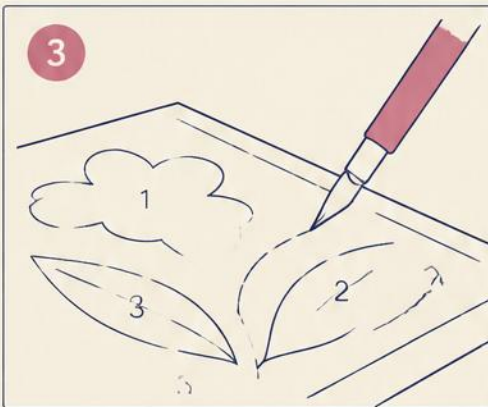
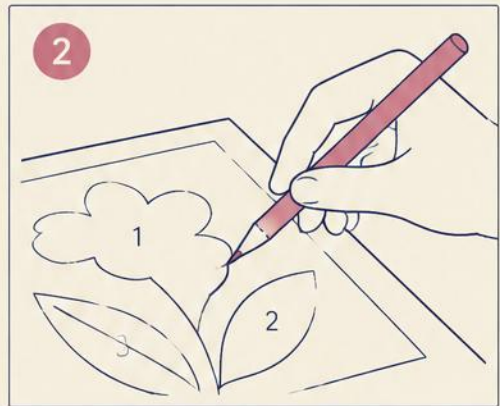
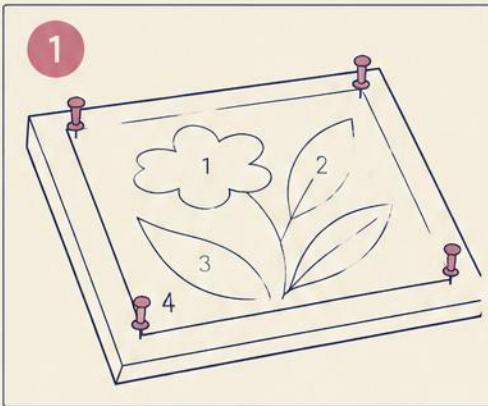
Printer software sometimes automatically scales your document to fit the page. To make sure the numbered regions match the foam board exactly, disable “fit to page” and print at actual size (100%).



Cutting The Foam Board

TRANSFER AND CUT

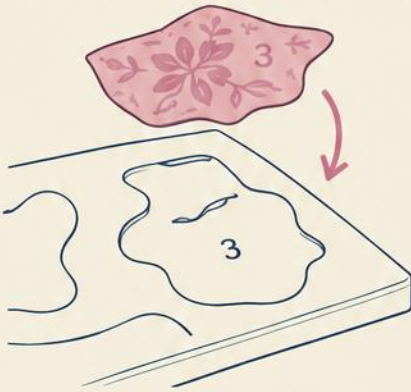
1. Pin the printed template to the foam board
2. Trace each numbered region line with light pressure
3. Cut a shallow groove along each traced line — do not cut all the way through
4. Remove the paper template once all grooves are cut



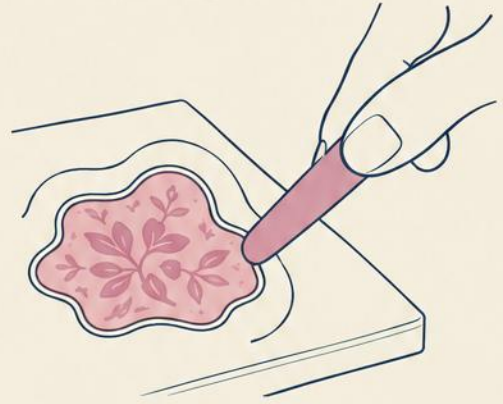
Your First Tuck

THE BASIC TUCK

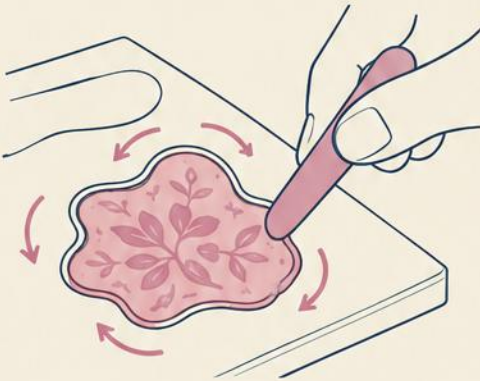
1. Lay your fabric patch over the matching numbered region, right side up.



2. Use the flat edge of your tool to push the fabric edge into the groove.



3. Work around the shape, tucking a little at a time.



4. Trim any excess fabric flush with the board.



TIP:

Tuck the background regions first, then work inward.

Textile & Colour Pairing



Choosing The Right Fabric

FABRIC TYPES THAT WORK BEST



Quilting cotton

— the easiest to tuck,
holds a crisp edge



Chintz or polished cotton

— adds a subtle sheen
for water and sky



Avoid stretch knits and very thick fabrics

— they resist tucking cleanly

Colour Theory Basics

THREE RULES THAT ALWAYS WORK

1

Pick one dominant colour family for 60% of the piece

2

Add one accent colour for contrast regions

3

Use a neutral cream or ink fabric for background regions



Warm Palette Pairings

WARM PALETTE



Terracotta



Dusty Rose



Golden Ochre



Warm Cream



Soft Ink

Best for: sunflowers, farmhouse scenes, autumn ridgelines.



Cool Palette Pairings

COOL PALETTE



Deep
Indigo



Slate
Blue



Seafoam



Pale
Cream



Charcoal
Ink



Best for: ocean scenes, night skies,
mountain ridges.

Mixing Textures

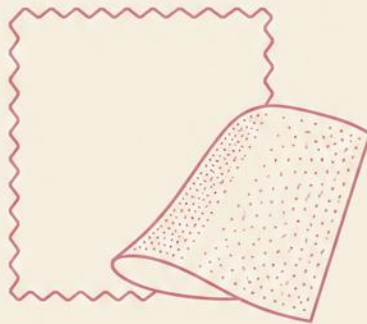
TEXTURE ADDS DEPTH

Combine a matte cotton background with one shimmering fabric accent for focal regions like a moon, a flower centre or water highlights.



TIP

Reserve your one shiny fabric for the smallest, most important region.



Common Colour Mistakes

WHAT TO AVOID

- ✗ Using more than one bold print at once
- ✗ Placing two similar mid-tones side by side — they read as one blob
- ✗ Skipping a neutral background fabric
- ✗ Ignoring the mood note before picking colours



Building A Fabric Kit

YOUR STARTER FABRIC KIT



1
Indigo



2
Rose



3
Cream



4
Ink



5
Ochre



6
Sage

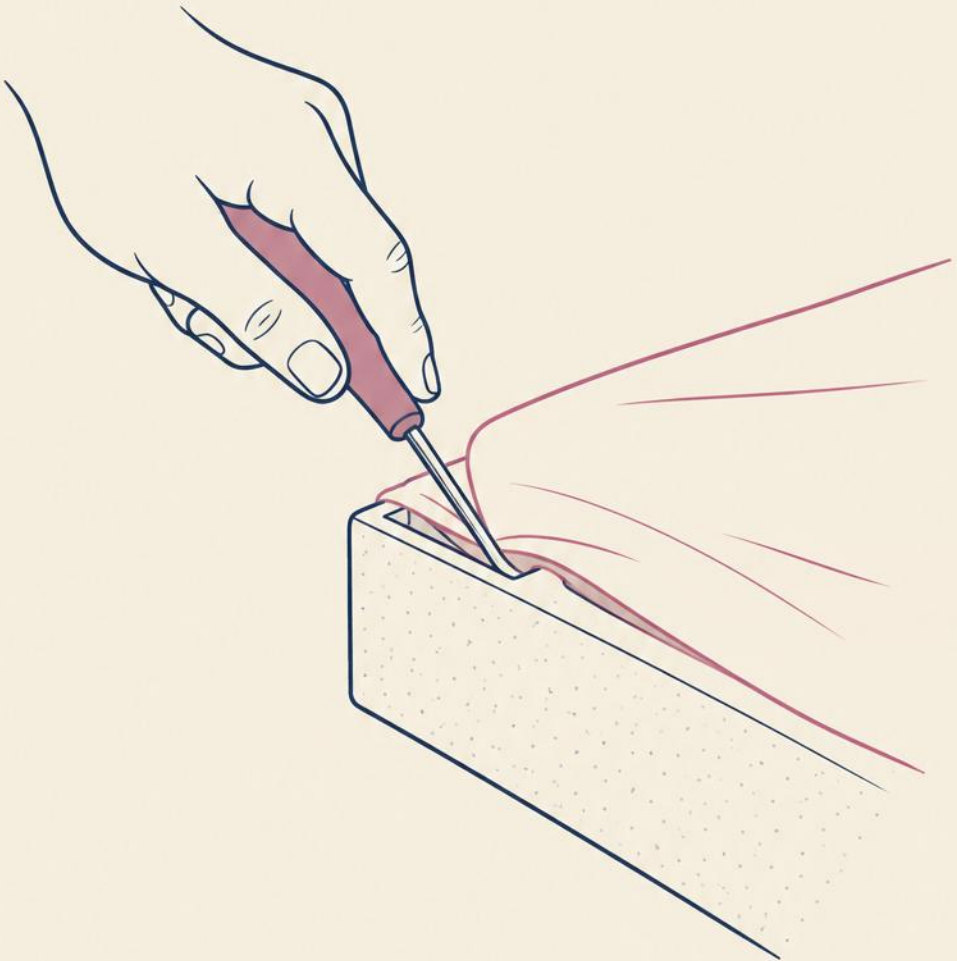


7
Terracotta



8
Slate

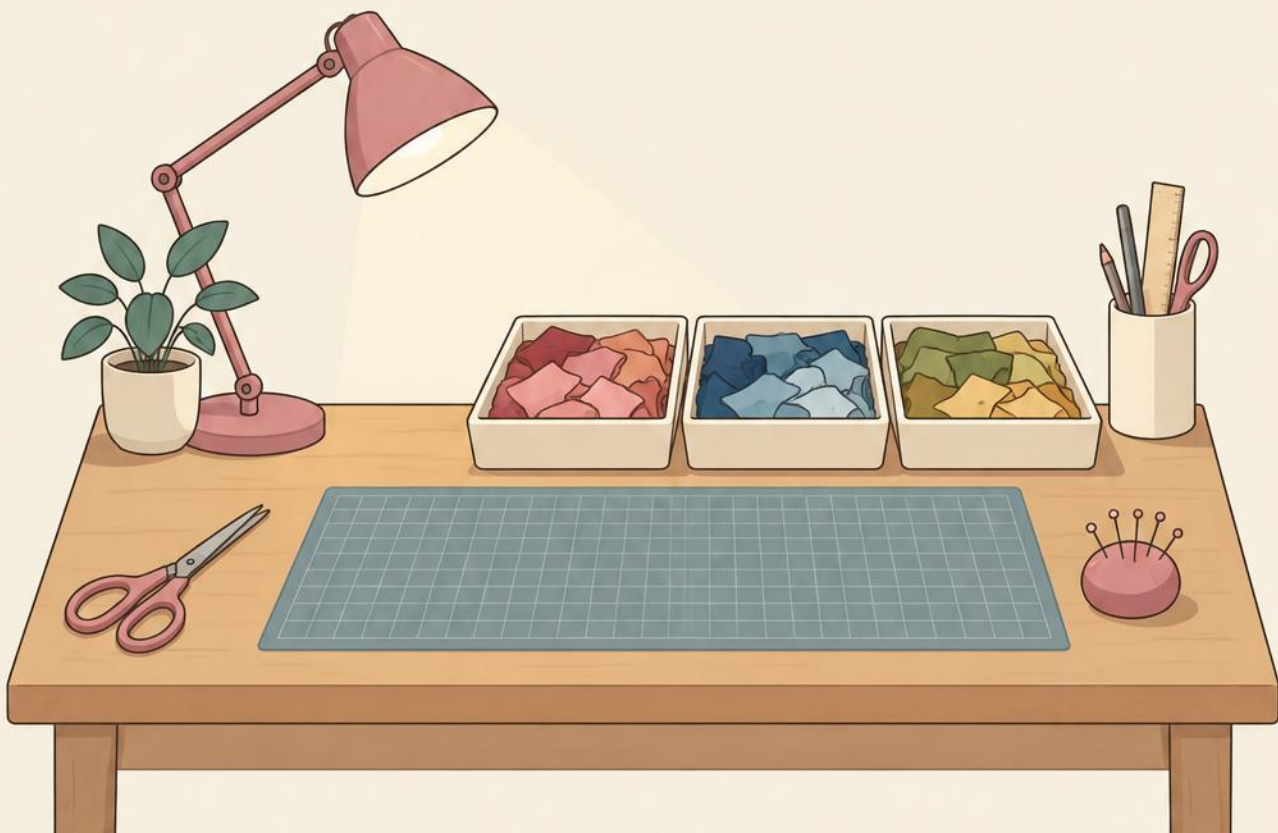
Craft & Refine Techniques



Preparing Your Workspace

SET UP FOR SUCCESS

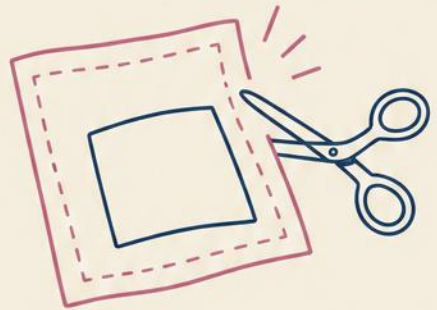
Start with a clean, flat table, good side lighting, and keep your fabric scraps sorted by colour in small trays before you begin a session.



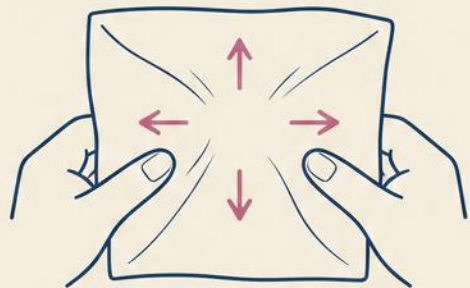
The Tuck Technique, Refined

A CLEANER TUCK

1. Cut fabric patches slightly larger than the region, never smaller.



2. Push from the centre outward, not corner first.



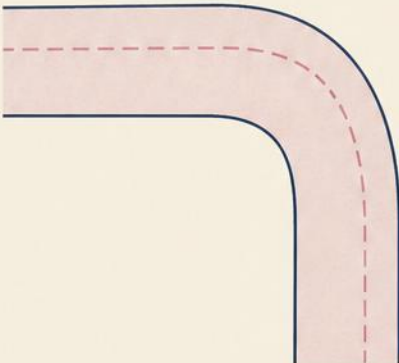
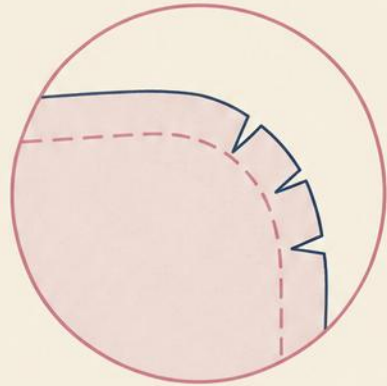
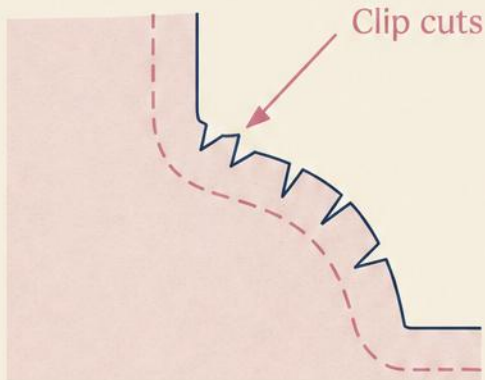
3. Re-tuck any loose edge immediately — cold fabric holds a groove better than a rushed one.



Corners And Tight Curves

CORNERS AND CURVES

Tight curves need small clip cuts into the fabric seam allowance every few millimetres so the fabric can bend smoothly into the groove without bunching.



Fixing Mistakes

IT'S NOT RUINED



Fabric popped
loose

Re-tuck with a touch
more fabric overlap



Wrong colour
in a region

Lift gently with your
tool and swap the patch



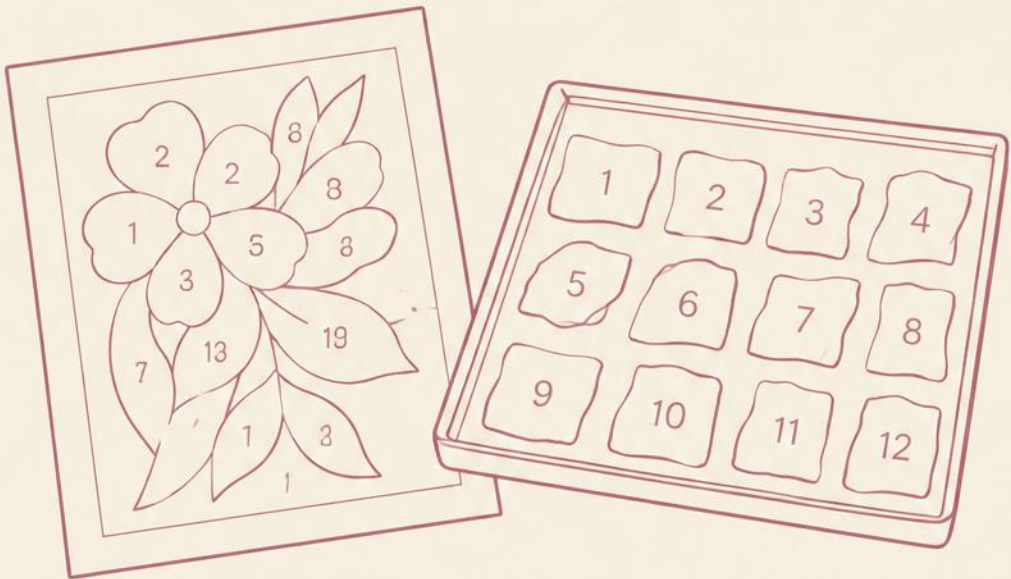
Groove cut
too shallow

Re-trace with slightly
more pressure and
try again

Working With Detailed Templates

MEDIUM-HARD TEMPLATES

Work on one small cluster of regions at a time when using detailed designs. Keep your fabric patches numbered on a tray to match the template before you start to tuck.



Framing Your Finished Piece

FRAMING AND FINISHING

1

Use a simple thin wood or matte black frame — let the fabric be the detail.



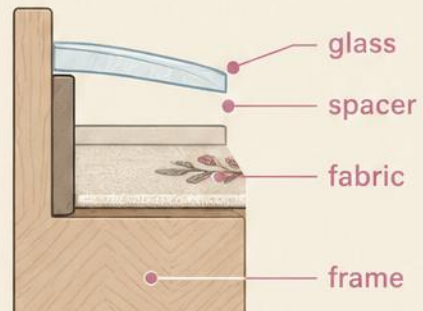
2

A cream mat border adds breathing room around detailed pieces.



3

Avoid glass touching the fabric directly — use a spacer or deep frame.



CRAFT & REFINE TECHNIQUES

You're Ready



YOU HAVE EVERYTHING YOU NEED

Method, palette, and technique — the three guides in this trilogy cover everything between an empty foam board and a framed piece on your wall. Pick a design, pick a palette, and start tucking.